

True-Safeguard Sleep Guide

The Biological Foundation of Digital Safety

I. The Science of the "Digital Sunset"

Quality sleep is not merely "rest"—it is a neurological cleanup process. When children consume high-intensity blue light before bed, it suppresses **Melatonin**, the hormone responsible for deep sleep, and elevates **Cortisol**, the stress hormone.

The "Blue Light Trap"

Digital screens emit short-wavelength light that mimics sunlight. This tricks the brain's *Suprachiasmatic Nucleus* into thinking it is midday, delaying the onset of sleep by up to 90 minutes and reducing the quality of REM sleep.

The 3-2-1 Decompression Protocol

3

Hours

No heavy meals to prevent metabolic wakefulness.

2

Hours

End all homework and high-stress cognitive tasks.

1

Hour

Total Blackout of all digital devices (No LED screens).

II. Clinical Sleep Requirements

Sleep debt is cumulative. Missing just one hour of sleep per night for a week results in the cognitive impairment of an entire night spent awake.

Developmental Stage	Hours Needed	Signs of Tech-Induced Debt
Preschool (3-5)	10–13 Hours	Night terrors, sudden hyperactivity, or aggressive meltdowns.
School Age (6-12)	9–12 Hours	Inability to focus in class, "glazed" morning eyes, or slow processing.
Adolescents (13-18)	8–10 Hours	Revenge Bedtime Procrastination and severe mood swings.

III. Sleep Environment Audit

The "Bedroom Sanctuary" Checklist

- **Charging Zone:** No devices (phones, tablets, laptops) are allowed in the bedroom overnight. They are parked in a central family charging station.
- **Visual Dark:** All status lights on routers or monitors are covered. Use blackout curtains to block streetlights.
- **The Cool Factor:** Maintain a room temperature between 65-68°F (18-20°C) to facilitate the core body temperature drop required for sleep.

The "Screen Crash" Recovery

If a child is overstimulated ("Tired but Wired"), they cannot jump straight to sleep. Use a 15-minute **Tactile Bridge**: Jigsaw puzzles, drawing, or reading a physical book to lower cortisol levels naturally.